
12
MAR
2020
MAKER AUCTION
0 DAI

BLACK THURSDAY

055 / 12 MAR 2020 / BITCOIN / RARE

STILL HODLING.

On 12 March 2020, the pandemic panic reached crypto with extraordinary force. Bitcoin dropped below US$6,000 as shares fell across the world. The previous day, the World Health Organization had characterised COVID-19 as a pandemic. Markets were reacting to a rapidly changing global crisis.

Bitcoin was caught in the same rush for liquidity as other assets. The episode challenged the expectation that it would automatically shelter investors from a wider market shock. In US equities, a market-wide circuit breaker paused trading for 15 minutes on 12 March.

The pressure also reached decentralised finance. Falling Ether prices pushed some MakerDAO vaults below their required collateral levels. Ethereum congestion and reduced competition among auction keepers helped some liquidation auctions clear for zero DAI, leaving a shortfall in the system.

Black Thursday exposed the practical limits of systems that depended on timely transactions, available liquidity and competitive bidders. A working blockchain did not guarantee that every mechanism built around it would behave as expected during an extreme sell-off.

The fictional HODL character returns from card 021, lying on the floor beneath a towering bear while red market candles crash around him. His familiar hoodie, Bitcoin mug and network poster connect the scenes. STILL HODLING. describes his resolve within the illustration; it makes no promise about the wisdom or outcome of holding.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE RETURNING HODLER

The black hoodie, Bitcoin mug and network poster echo card 021. This is the collection’s fictional character, not a portrait of a documented investor.

02 12 MAR 2020

The fallen calendar anchors Black Thursday. Towering red candlesticks and the wrecked city turn pandemic fear and market losses into visual metaphor.

03 MAKER AUCTION / 0 DAI

The newspaper refers to some MakerDAO collateral auctions that cleared for zero DAI. It is external news, not a receipt showing the character’s Bitcoin being liquidated.

04 THE BEAR MARKET

The giant bear towers over the fallen HODL character, turning a market sell-off into a physical threat. Its weight amid the rubble makes the pressure of the crash visible.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Sources: CoinDesk, 12 March 2020; MakerDAO response thread; NYSE market review; WHO, 11 March 2020. The character, room and destruction are fictional imagery. No literal destruction of a city is claimed. The phrase is original editorial wording, not financial advice.